

BONUS 2 OF 3

Yarn & Hook Chart

Which hook to use with each yarn, so you never have to guess at the store.

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SECTION 1

How yarn weight works

The number on the label tells you which hook to start with.

Yarn is sold by weight, which means thickness. The number on the label (from 0 to 7) is the standard the yarn industry uses, and it is the fastest way to choose a hook.

LABEL NUMBER	NAME	ALSO CALLED	HOOK THE LABEL USUALLY SUGGESTS
1	Super fine	Fingering, sock, baby	2.25 to 3.5 mm (B-1 to E-4)
2	Fine	Sport, baby	3.5 to 4.5 mm (E-4 to 7)
3	Light	DK, light worsted	4.5 to 5.5 mm (7 to I-9)
4	Medium	Worsted, aran, afghan	5.5 to 6.5 mm (I-9 to K-10½)
5	Bulky	Chunky, craft, rug	6.5 to 9 mm (K-10½ to M/N-13)
6	Super bulky	Roving	9 mm and larger
7	Jumbo	Jumbo	15 mm and larger

Read this

These are the ranges labels usually suggest. Many projects use a different hook on purpose. Toys use a smaller hook than the label, and drapery garments sometimes use a larger one. Every CrochetLib pattern lists the hook it was written for.

SECTION 2

Hook size conversion

Millimeters and US letters side by side.

Hooks are labeled in millimeters, US letters and numbers, or both. Always trust the millimeters: letters differ a little between brands.

MILLIMETERS	US SIZE
2.25 mm	B-1
2.75 mm	C-2
3.25 mm	D-3
3.5 mm	E-4
3.75 mm	F-5
4.0 mm	G-6
4.5 mm	7
5.0 mm	H-8
5.5 mm	I-9
6.0 mm	J-10
6.5 mm	K-10½
8.0 mm	L-11
9.0 mm	M/N-13
10.0 mm	N/P-15

Tip

Write the millimeters on a small piece of tape and stick it on the hook handle if it has no marking.

SECTION 3

The hooks CrochetLib patterns use

Every hook used in the patterns, with the patterns that use it.

This table is built from the patterns in your library, so it always matches what each pattern asks for.

HOOK	PATTERNS THAT USE IT
3.5 mm (E-4)	Baby Penguin, Bat, Black Cat, Carrot Toy, Cheerful Snowman, Christmas Tree, Chubby Kitty, Classic Teddy Bear, Cuddly Fox, Cute Spider, Daisy Motif, Decorated Easter Eggs, Easter Bunny, Floppy Ear Bunny, Fluffy Chick, Gingerbread Man, Jack-o-Lantern Pumpkin, Leafy Garland, Little Cactus in Pot, Little Elephant, Little Ghost, Little Lamb, Little Mummy, Little Reindeer, Mini Heart Keychain, Mini Santa Ornament, Rosebud, Sleepy Owl, Snowflake Ornament, Soft Baby Rattle, Succulent in Pot, Sunflower Motif, Tulip
3.5 mm (E-4) for the head, 4.0 mm (G-6) for the blanket	Snuggle Lovey
4.0 mm (G-6)	Baby Beanie, Baby Bib, Baby Booties, Baby Mittens, Christmas Stocking, Everyday Scrunchie, Fingerless Gloves, Flat Market Clutch, Phone Crossbody Bag, Plant Pot Cover, Set of 4 Coasters, Storage Basket
4.5 mm (7)	Cotton Dishcloth, Drawstring Pouch, Mini Drawstring Backpack, Round Bucket Bag
5.0 mm (H-8)	Baby Granny Blanket, Beach Cover-Up, Beginner Poncho, Boho Wall Hanging, Bunny Ears Headband, Cozy Leg Warmers, Easter Basket, Easy Tube Skirt, Everyday Mesh Tote, Granny Square Throw, Granny Square Tote, Granny Square Vest, Kids Poncho, Pillow Cover, Rectangle Shrug, Slouchy Beanie, Trick-or-Treat Basket, Twisted Headband
8.0 mm (L-11)	Chunky Scarf, Infinity Cowl

SECTION 4

Choosing by project

What to reach for depending on what you are making.

PROJECT	YARN THAT WORKS WELL	HOOK IDEA	WHY
Toys and amigurumi	Cotton or acrylic, weight 3 or 4, smooth	About 1 to 2 mm smaller than the label suggests	Tight stitches hide the stuffing and keep the shape.
Bags, baskets, coasters	Cotton, weight 4	The size in the pattern, often 4.0 to 5.0 mm	Cotton has no stretch, so bags and baskets hold their shape.
Blankets and throws	Soft acrylic or a blend, weight 4	Label size or one size larger	A slightly larger hook gives a softer, faster fabric.
Hats, scarves, cowls	Wool blend or soft acrylic, weight 4 or 5	Label size	Some stretch and warmth.
Baby items	Soft, washable yarn, weight 2 to 4	Label size	Look for a yarn made for baby items and easy washing.
Flowers and small motifs	Cotton, weight 3 or 4	Smaller than the label	Firm stitches keep petals crisp.
Dishcloths and kitchen items	Cotton, weight 4	About 4.5 to 5.0 mm	Cotton absorbs water and washes well.

SECTION 5

Fibers in plain words

What each common yarn does for your project.

FIBER	GOOD AT	WATCH OUT FOR
Cotton	Holds its shape, absorbs water, stays crisp. Great for bags, baskets, coasters, kitchen items and toys.	Little stretch, so it can be hard on the hands. Splits more easily than smooth yarn.
Acrylic	Budget friendly, soft, many colors, easy to wash. Great for toys, blankets and baby items.	Can look flat. Follow the label for washing and drying.
Wool and wool blends	Warm, stretchy, springs back. Great for hats, scarves and cowls.	Some wool must be washed by hand. Check the label.
Cotton and acrylic blends	A good middle ground: soft and with a little structure.	Weights and yardage vary by brand, so check the label.

If you sell or gift finished pieces, check the care label of the yarn and pass the care instructions to the person who gets it.

SECTION 6

Make a swatch first

Two minutes now can save a whole project.

A swatch is a small square you crochet to see how your hands and your hook work with a yarn. It tells you if the yarn and hook you picked are a good match.

- 1 Chain 20 and work about 4 inches (10 cm) of single crochet, or the stitch your pattern uses.
- 2 Lay it flat without stretching and look at it with the pattern beside you.
- 3 If the stitches look too loose or floppy, try a hook one size smaller.
- 4 If the fabric feels stiff or the stitches are hard to work, try a hook one size larger.
- 5 For toys, hold the swatch up to the light. If you can see light through the stitches, go down a hook size.

Rule of thumb

Changing one hook size changes the fabric a little. Changing two makes a very noticeable difference. Change one at a time and compare.

SECTION 7

Swapping yarn and buying enough

How to use a different yarn than the pattern says.

- 1 Match the label number (the yarn weight) first: a weight 4 pattern needs a weight 4 yarn.
- 2 Match the fiber to the job: cotton for bags and baskets, soft acrylic for toys and baby items.
- 3 Use the yardage in the pattern. Two yarns of the same weight can have very different yardage in a ball, so compare yards or meters, not ounces or grams.
- 4 Buy a little extra of the main color, about one extra ball, in case your tension differs.
- 5 Buy all the yarn for one project at the same time. Dye lots can differ slightly between purchases.

At the store

- ☐ The label number matches the pattern.
- ☐ The fiber matches the project.
- ☐ You have enough yards or meters, plus a little extra.
- ☐ All balls of the same color come from the same dye lot.
- ☐ You have the hook size written down in millimeters.

Next step

Open CrochetLib from your access page and check the hook and yarn of your next pattern against this chart before you buy anything.